

AUTHORITY · TRUST · CLIENT GROWTH

Client Onboarding CPAs

A refined client-growth system for turning expertise into clearer communication, better follow-up, stronger referral touchpoints, and more trusted advisory relationships.

01

CLARIFY THE CLIENT CONVERSATION

02

FOLLOW UP WITH MORE AUTHORITY

03

BUILD TRUST BEFORE THE CONSULT

USE THE SYSTEM

Make expertise easier to trust.

Start with the asset closest to the next client moment: inquiry response, consultation follow-up, referral nurture, renewal conversation, education content, or retention touchpoint.

01

Lead with context

Adapt each asset around the client's situation, risk, urgency, and decision stage.

02

Sound clear, not canned

Keep the structure, then add the details that prove the client was heard.

03

Review before sending

Check every client-facing asset for accuracy, compliance, and professional tone.

GROWTH SYSTEM

Client Onboarding CPAs

Use these assets to make client communication clearer, more consistent, and easier to act on.

01

CLIENT SYSTEM

Client Onboarding, Advisory Scripts & Partnership

Templates

02

CLIENT SYSTEM

New Client Questionnaire, Advisory Upsell Scripts, Irs Notice Response Guide, CPA Partnership

proposal, and year-end planning system

03

CLIENT SYSTEM

Questionnaire

Send before every new client engagement. Completed intake improves the quality of the first planning conversation and signals a professional, systematic practice. ✓ Full legal name (individual) / Business legal name: ✓ Date of birth (individual) / Business formation date: ✓ Social Security Number / EIN: [collect securely — do not send via unencrypted

04

CLIENT SYSTEM

Email]

✓ Address: ✓ Phone: ✓ Email: ✓ How did you hear about [Firm Name]? ✓ Filing status (individual): Single / MFJ / MFS / HOH / QW ✓ Occupation / Industry: ✓ Primary reason for engaging a CPA (what problem are you trying to solve?): ✓ Have you worked with a CPA before? If yes, who and when? ✓ Do you need us to obtain your prior year returns? If yes, from whom? ✓ Current bookkeeping software (if business): QuickBooks / Xero / Wave / Spreadsheet / None ✓ Do you have an accountant, bookkeeper, or financial advisor you work with? If yes, who? ✓ Are there any time-sensitive issues — IRS notices, upcoming deadlines,

05

CLIENT SYSTEM

Email]

transactions — we should know about?

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01

CLIENT SYSTEM

Client Communication Asset

✓ What does a successful relationship with your CPA look like to you? ✓ [This questionnaire sets the foundation for an exceptional first meeting. Clients who complete it start with clarity and confidence — and so do you.]

02

CLIENT SYSTEM

Conversation Scripts

Introducing Tax Planning to a Compliance-Only Client

03

CLIENT SYSTEM

Script — Advisory Services Introduction Conversation

YOU: I want to raise something with you that I think could make a real difference to your tax bill — and I want to be direct about it because I think you're leaving money on the table. YOU: Everything we've done together has been compliance-focused — accurate returns, filed on time. That's important. But there's another layer that most clients don't know to ask about: proactive planning. YOU: Planning means we look at your situation in [Q3/Q4 / mid-year], make decisions about income timing, deductions, retirement contributions, entity structure — before December 31, when there's still something we can do.

04

CLIENT SYSTEM

Script — Advisory Services Introduction Conversation

Right now we're mostly reporting what happened. YOU: Based on [specific thing about their situation — income level, business structure, upcoming transaction], I think there are real opportunities. Would you be open to a planning conversation? [Frame it as serving their interests, not selling a service. You're a professional advisor who sees an opportunity to help — not a salesperson looking to upsell.] When a Client Asks 'What Else Can You Do For Me?'

05

CLIENT SYSTEM

Script — Full Service Discovery Conversation

YOU: Great question — I'd love to walk you through what we offer beyond tax preparation. YOU: For [business owners], we can help with: bookkeeping and financial statement preparation, payroll, quarterly estimated tax planning, business structure

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01

CLIENT SYSTEM

Client Communication Asset

optimisation, and what I'd call CFO-lite advisory — being a sounding board when you're making big financial decisions. YOU: For [individuals], beyond the annual return, we can do: year-round tax planning, assistance with major transactions like real estate or business sales, IRS representation if you ever receive a notice, and estate planning coordination alongside your attorney. YOU: The clients I have the most impact with are the ones I hear from more than once a year. What matters most to you right now? [Let them tell you what they need. Then match your services to their stated priorities.]

02

CLIENT SYSTEM

Irs Notice Triage — What To Tell Clients Immediately

✓ CP2000 — Underreporter inquiry: IRS matching return data. Common, not an audit. Respond within 60 days. ✓ CP503 / CP504 — Balance due notices: Taxes owed. Address promptly to avoid lien. ✓ CP90 / 1058 — Intent to levy: Urgent. Contact client immediately. ✓ Letter 3219 — Notice of deficiency: 90-day letter. Do not ignore. ✓ Letter 525 / 531 — Audit examination: Respond through proper channels. ✓ CP01 / CP01A — Identity protection: Identity theft or PIN issue. ✓ [Rule: Never let clients respond to IRS notices directly without speaking to you first. The response matters as much as the issue.]

03

CLIENT SYSTEM

Subject You Received An Irs Notice — Here's What To Do, [First Name]

Dear [First Name], Thank you for forwarding the IRS notice. I've reviewed it and want to give you some immediate context so you're not worrying unnecessarily. What this notice is: [plain-language explanation of the specific notice type and what triggered it].

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01

CLIENT SYSTEM

Client Communication Asset

What it is NOT: [reassurance where appropriate — e.g., 'This is not an audit. It is a routine matching notice.'] What happens next: - I will [specific action — draft response / review the discrepancy / request an account transcript] by [date] - Your response deadline: [date] — we have sufficient time - I may need from you: [any specific information or documents] Please do not contact the IRS directly — let me handle the response. This is exactly the type of situation where having a CPA in your corner matters. I'll update you by [date]. [Your Name] | [Firm Name] | [Phone]

02

CLIENT SYSTEM

Proposal

Co-Referral Partnership Proposal Email

03

CLIENT SYSTEM

Subject A Partnership Idea — [Your Name] + [Their Name]

Dear [Name], I've been thinking about how we might build a more structured referral relationship and wanted to put a specific idea on the table. The overlap between our clients is significant: [attorney: 'your estate planning and business law clients routinely need tax guidance on the transactions and structures you're creating' / financial advisor: 'your investment and planning clients almost always have tax implications that affect their overall strategy']. What I'm proposing: Option A — Warm introductions: when either of us identifies a need the other can serve,

04

CLIENT SYSTEM

Subject A Partnership Idea — [Your Name] + [Their Name]

we make a personal introduction rather than just passing a business card. Option B — Joint client meetings: for clients we share, we meet together once or twice a year to coordinate their planning holistically. Option C — Educational event: we co-host a workshop for small business owners / high-net-worth individuals — you cover [their expertise], I cover [tax/accounting angle]. Shared audience, shared credibility. Happy to do any or all of these. Would a brief call work this week? Sincerely, [Your Name] | [Firm Name] | [Phone]